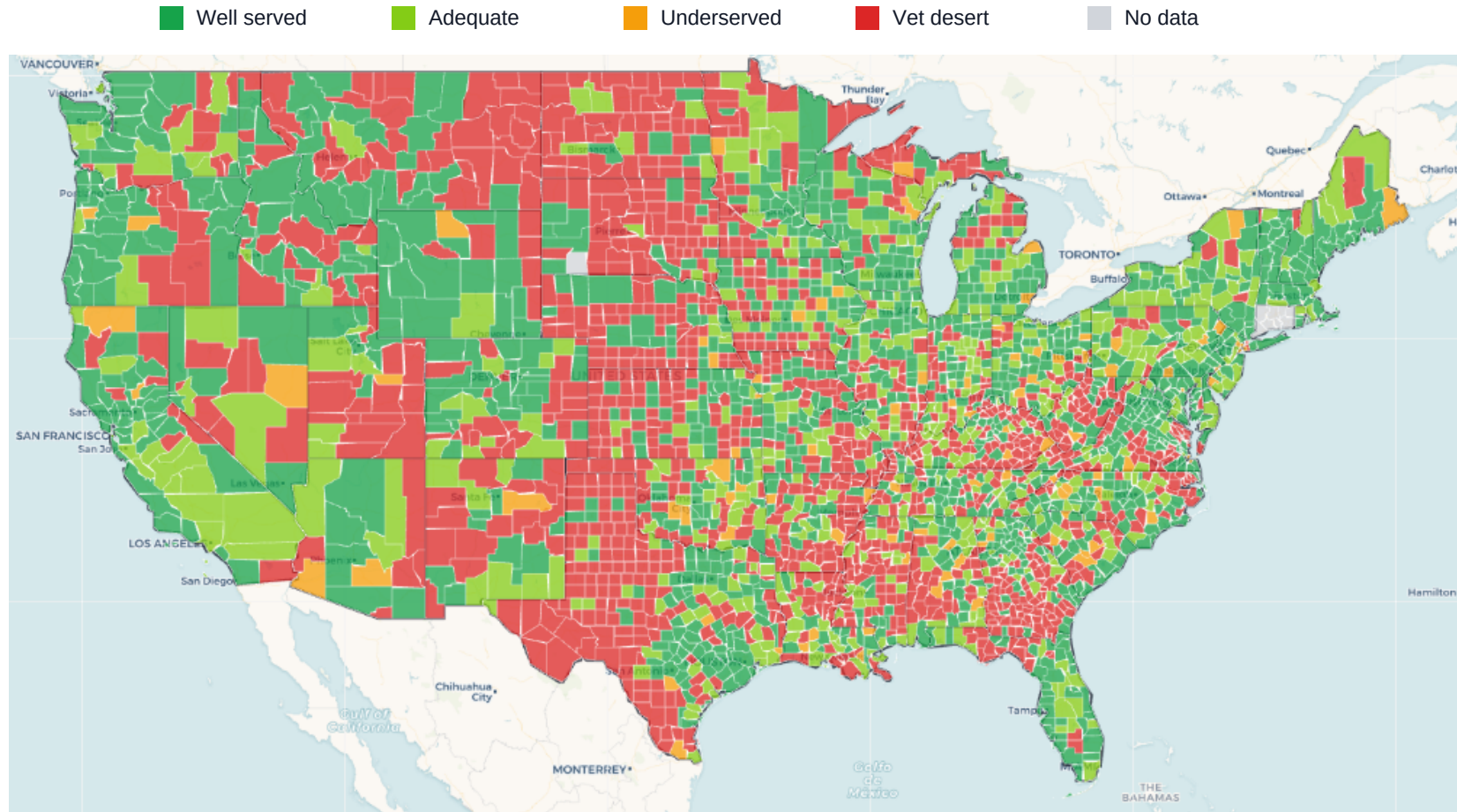


United States: County-Level Veterinary Access

46% of U.S. counties (1,439 of 3,144) are underserved or classified as a vet desert — an estimated **14,012,900** households (11%) with limited access to in-person veterinary care.



County-level analysis · U.S. Census Bureau 2022 County Business Patterns (NAICS 541940, Veterinary Services) + ACS5 household estimates. Counties with no reported vet establishments are scored as deserts. Directional estimate, not the official Veterinary Care Accessibility Project index. Refreshed August 06, 2026.

State Breakdown

Ranked by share of counties that are underserved or a vet desert — figures to cite directly in a pitch or RFP response.

STATE	COUNTIES AT RISK	% UNDERSERVED / DESERT	HOUSEHOLDS AT RISK
Alaska (AK)	25 / 30	83%	45,910 / 264,376
North Dakota (ND)	42 / 53	79%	88,941 / 320,038
South Dakota (SD)	50 / 66	76%	100,362 / 351,182
Nebraska (NE)	65 / 93	70%	133,444 / 776,379
Arkansas (AR)	49 / 75	65%	317,098 / 1,171,694
Kentucky (KY)	75 / 120	62%	467,837 / 1,769,102
Montana (MT)	35 / 56	62%	83,073 / 443,917
West Virginia (WV)	34 / 55	62%	234,888 / 716,040
Mississippi (MS)	50 / 82	61%	324,681 / 1,121,269
Utah (UT)	17 / 29	59%	67,005 / 1,062,819
Kansas (KS)	61 / 105	58%	192,502 / 1,148,635
Texas (TX)	141 / 254	56%	865,696 / 10,490,553
Georgia (GA)	88 / 159	55%	655,822 / 3,946,490
Louisiana (LA)	33 / 64	52%	292,034 / 1,765,264
Missouri (MO)	58 / 115	50%	448,660 / 2,458,324
Alabama (AL)	32 / 67	48%	266,960 / 1,933,150
New Mexico (NM)	16 / 33	48%	90,253 / 812,852
South Carolina (SC)	22 / 46	48%	287,756 / 2,023,085

STATE	COUNTIES AT RISK	% UNDERSERVED / DESERT	HOUSEHOLDS AT RISK
Arizona (AZ)	7 / 15	47%	286,838 / 2,739,136
Nevada (NV)	8 / 17	47%	13,778 / 1,163,671
Oklahoma (OK)	36 / 77	47%	193,373 / 1,522,711
Iowa (IA)	46 / 99	46%	214,369 / 1,290,139
Virginia (VA)	60 / 133	45%	553,337 / 3,289,776
Minnesota (MN)	38 / 87	44%	199,905 / 2,256,126
Tennessee (TN)	42 / 95	44%	364,155 / 2,713,635
Idaho (ID)	19 / 44	43%	55,888 / 675,323
Hawaii (HI)	2 / 5	40%	23,010 / 483,906
Illinois (IL)	41 / 102	40%	225,544 / 4,968,761
North Carolina (NC)	39 / 100	39%	467,177 / 4,105,232
Colorado (CO)	24 / 64	38%	49,052 / 2,278,044
Indiana (IN)	35 / 92	38%	314,428 / 2,653,596
Michigan (MI)	27 / 83	33%	870,420 / 4,009,253
Wyoming (WY)	7 / 23	30%	21,872 / 234,156
Florida (FL)	18 / 67	27%	126,063 / 8,353,441
Ohio (OH)	23 / 88	26%	365,745 / 4,789,408
Washington (WA)	10 / 39	26%	54,269 / 2,979,272
Oregon (OR)	9 / 36	25%	57,104 / 1,680,800
Pennsylvania (PA)	15 / 67	22%	903,093 / 5,193,727
Wisconsin (WI)	13 / 72	18%	87,365 / 2,425,488
California (CA)	10 / 58	17%	129,839 / 13,315,822

STATE	COUNTIES AT RISK	% UNDERSERVED / DESERT	HOUSEHOLDS AT RISK
New Jersey (NJ)	3 / 21	14%	627,740 / 3,438,162
Vermont (VT)	2 / 14	14%	5,694 / 265,858
Maine (ME)	2 / 16	12%	21,239 / 580,172
New York (NY)	8 / 62	13%	2,559,436 / 7,604,523
Maryland (MD)	2 / 24	8%	259,245 / 2,318,124
Connecticut (CT)	0 / 9	0%	0 / 1,409,807
Delaware (DE)	0 / 3	0%	0 / 389,000
District of Columbia (DC)	0 / 1	0%	0 / 315,785
Massachusetts (MA)	0 / 14	0%	0 / 2,740,995
New Hampshire (NH)	0 / 10	0%	0 / 545,116
Rhode Island (RI)	0 / 5	0%	0 / 432,219